CSSD Specialist

Nursing · Nursing & Allied Health

Job title	CSSD Specialist	**Job code**	JD-HRM-070
Department	Nursing	**Division**	Nursing & Allied Health
Grade	AH2	**Reports to**	CSSD Supervisor
Supervises	CSSD Technicians (as assigned)	**SCFHS licence**	Yes — Category 5 — Allied Health Professional

Job Summary

Performs sterilization, decontamination, and reprocessing of medical instruments and supplies in accordance with CBAHI IPC standards and established CSSD policies. Operates sterilization equipment, conducts quality checks, and ensures proper packaging, labeling, and storage of sterile items.

Essential Duties & Responsibilities

1. Performs decontamination, cleaning, inspection, packaging, sterilization, and storage of surgical instruments, medical devices, and reusable supplies following established protocols and manufacturer instructions.
2. Operates sterilizers (autoclaves, ETO, plasma) following proper parameters for time, temperature, and pressure. Records sterilization cycle data including load lists, lot numbers, and operator identification (CBAHI IPC.19.4).
3. Performs daily sterilizer function tests, Bowie-Dick tests, and chemical indicator checks. Assists with weekly biological indicator testing. Reports any abnormal results to the Senior Specialist or Supervisor immediately.
4. Inspects instruments after cleaning to ensure they are in good condition and fit for use. Assembles instrument trays accurately according to tray content lists. Verifies instrument counts before and after packaging.
5. Packages instruments and supplies using appropriate wrapping materials and techniques. Applies chemical indicators in every package. Labels packages with sterilization date, expiry date, lot number, and contents.
6. Manages sterile storage areas ensuring proper rotation (first-in-first-out), environmental conditions, and shelf-life monitoring. Identifies and removes expired items for reprocessing.
7. Transports contaminated items in safe closed biohazard containers from clinical areas to CSSD. Distributes sterile items to operating rooms, procedure areas, and clinical units as scheduled (CBAHI IPC.18.3).
8. Uses appropriate PPE during decontamination activities including heavy-duty gloves, waterproof aprons, facemasks, boots, and goggles/face shields (CBAHI IPC.21.1).
9. Maintains cleanliness of CSSD work areas and equipment. Performs routine cleaning and maintenance of washers, ultrasonic cleaners, and sterilizers per manufacturer guidelines.
10. Documents all processing activities accurately and in a timely manner. Maintains traceability records for all sterilized items.
11. Follows all hospital-related policies and procedures. Participates in self and others' education, training, and development. Performs other related duties as assigned.

Qualifications: Education, Training & Experience

1. Education — Diploma in CSSD Technology, Health Sciences, or related discipline is required. Bachelor's Degree is preferred.

2. Experience — 1 year of CSSD experience is required. New graduates with CSSD diploma may be considered with structured training.
3. Licence / Certification — SCFHS registration as CSSD Technician is required. CRCST certification is preferred.

Skills

1. Sterile Processing: Decontamination, assembly and sterilisation technique.
2. Quality Control: Sterilizer monitoring, indicator interpretation and load release.
3. Communication: Effective liaison with OR, nursing and IPC teams.
4. Equipment Handling: Operation, QC and troubleshooting of sterilisers/washer-disinfectors.
5. Technology: Use of instrument-tracking and sterilizer-record systems.
6. Organisation: Workflow, inventory and documentation management.

Knowledge

1. Advanced decontamination, assembly and sterilisation (steam, ETO, H2O2 plasma) and cycle-parameter selection.
2. Sterilisation validation and monitoring (biological, chemical, mechanical indicators), Bowie-Dick testing and load release.
3. Instrument traceability, recall management and sterile-storage conditions.
4. Knowledge of CBAHI National Hospital Standards and accreditation requirements.
5. Knowledge of GDIPC Infection Prevention & Control standards and hand-hygiene practice.
6. Knowledge of applicable KSA healthcare laws, regulations and the hospital Code of Conduct.

Attitude & Behaviour

1. Respect & Integrity
2. Patient-Centred Approach
3. Accountability
4. Continuous Learning
5. Teamwork & Collaboration
6. Confidentiality
7. Professionalism
8. Adaptability & Resilience
9. Compassion & Empathy
10. Commitment to Safety

Physical Requirements

- Prolonged standing and walking during shifts.
- Ability to lift/assist patients and equipment (up to ~20 kg) with safe technique.
- Manual dexterity for clinical/technical procedures.
- Use of personal protective equipment (PPE); potential exposure to clinical hazards.
- Shift work, night shifts and on-call duties as required by the unit.

Approval

Reviewed & recommended by	Department Head	**Approved by**	HR Manager

Staff acknowledgement and signature are recorded electronically through the AMH Staff Credentials Portal.